PASSWORD SECURITY

Poster 1 of 6 — Cyber Hygiene Series

STRONG PASSWORD RULES

14+	Minimum 14 characters for standard accounts. 20+ for admin.
Mix it up	Uppercase + lowercase + numbers + symbols. No dictionary words.
Never reuse	Every account needs a unique password. Use a password manager.
No sharing	Your password is yours alone — not even IT needs it.
Change on breach	Change immediately if you suspect a breach or receive an alert.

🔑 **Use a Password Manager — never write passwords on paper or in a spreadsheet.**

DON'T TAKE THE BAIT

PHISHING AWARENESS

6 RED FLAGS TO SPOT INSTANTLY

Suspicious sender domain

✗ Check the ACTUAL email address. 'absa-alerts.net' is NOT ABSA.

Urgency / threats

✗ 'Your account closes in 24hrs!' Panic is the attacker's weapon.

Generic greeting

✗ 'Dear Customer' — your bank knows your name.

Suspicious links

✗ Hover before clicking. Does the URL match the real domain?

Unexpected attachments

✗ Unexpected .zip, .pdf, .doc? Don't open it.

Requests for credentials

✗ No legitimate org asks for passwords or OTPs via email.

IF IN DOUBT: Do NOT click. Forward to security@[yourcompany.com] or press the 'Report Phishing' button.

DEVICE SECURITY

Your device is the gateway. Keep it secure.

🔒 Lock your screen

Set auto-lock to ≤5 minutes. Press Win+L or Cmd+Ctrl+Q whenever you step away.

🛡️ Full disk encryption ON

BitLocker (Windows) or FileVault (Mac) must be enabled. Ask IT if unsure.

⬆️ Update promptly

Apply OS and software updates within 7 days. Patches fix the vulnerabilities attackers exploit.

⚠️ No unauthorised software

Only install software approved by IT. Unapproved apps may contain malware.

🔑 MFA on everything

Multi-factor authentication adds a second lock. Enable it on all work accounts.

📞 Report lost/stolen devices immediately

Call IT Security within 1 hour. Remote wipe can protect data — but only if you act fast.

PUBLIC Wi-Fi DANGERS

THREATS ON PUBLIC NETWORKS

Man-in-the-Middle Attack

An attacker on the same network intercepts your traffic and reads your data — including login credentials.

Evil Twin / Fake Hotspot

'Free Airport WiFi' might actually be an attacker's hotspot harvesting your credentials and session tokens.

Session Hijacking

Attackers capture your session cookies from unencrypted connections to impersonate you on websites.

Malware Distribution

Compromised public networks can inject malware into file downloads or redirect browsers to malicious sites.

STAY SAFE ON PUBLIC Wi-Fi:

- ✓ Always use the company VPN — mandatory for any work activity
- ✓ Never access banking or sensitive systems on public Wi-Fi without VPN
- ✓ Disable Wi-Fi auto-connect. Forget public networks after use
- ✓ Prefer mobile data / personal hotspot for sensitive work

SOCIAL ENGINEERING

The attack that exploits PEOPLE, not technology

Social engineering is when attackers manipulate people — not systems — using psychology: authority, urgency, fear, curiosity, or helpfulness. No technical skills needed.

Pretexting

Attacker creates a fabricated scenario: 'I'm from SARS auditing your account' or 'I'm IT and need your password to fix your access.'

Baiting

Leaving a USB drive labelled 'Salary Review 2024' in the car park. Curiosity kills — and installs malware.

Quid Pro Quo

'I can fix your computer issue if you give me your login details.' Attackers offer help to gain access.

Tailgating

Following an authorised person through a secure door before it closes. Physical access enables digital attacks.

Impersonation

Impersonating IT, HR, or a supplier via phone, email, or in person to extract information or access.

Water-Holing

Compromising a website your team regularly visits (industry news, supplier portal) to deliver malware.

🛡️ DEFENCE: Verify identity independently. Never bypass procedures under 'urgent' pressure. If it feels off, it probably is.

REPORT IT.
DON'T IGNORE IT.

WHEN TO REPORT A SECURITY INCIDENT

- You clicked a suspicious link or opened an attachment
- You received a phishing email (even if you didn't click)
- Your device was lost, stolen, or accessed by someone else
- You noticed unusual account activity (unexpected logins, sent emails)
- A colleague or third party asked for your password or credentials
- You accidentally sent sensitive data to the wrong recipient
- You found an unattended USB drive or suspicious hardware
- A system is behaving strangely (slow, unexpected pop-ups, ransom notes)

HOW TO REPORT:

📞 **Call IT Security:** [Your IT Security Hotline Number]

📧 **Email:** security@[yourcompany.com]

🔘 Use the 'Report Phishing' button in Outlook/Gmail for suspected phishing emails

📝 **Log the incident:** Note time, system affected, and what happened